Project Management — Pothole Reporting & Road-Maintenance Accountability

Phase 1 (Planning): Working Document

Status: Draft v1. This file holds the Phase 1 material from the combined Phases 1 & 2 working document. Section numbers are the same as in the combined document, so references between sections still point to the right place. Section 10 (requirements), Section 17 (Phase 2 deliverables) and Section 20 (Day 2 addendum) are in the Phase 2 file.

Team (The City Fix Team): Project Management (operational accountability partners)

Target municipality (case focus): Emfuleni Local Municipality (Vereeniging, Gauteng) + Vaal Triangle neighbours (Midvaal; Metsimaholo/Free State)

Date of consolidation: 2026-10-07

Purpose: Planning baseline for the project. It covers the Phase 1 deliverables inventory, objective and scope, desk research, as-is workflow, thematic analysis, pain points and opportunities, channel inventory, team charter, project plan, risk register, urgent-pothole definition, driver interview question set, task board, and data sources and limitations.

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1. Phase 1 Deliverables Inventory (Draft v1 unless marked)

#	Deliverable	Status	Notes
1.1	Signed team charter	Draft v1 (below, Section 11)	To be signed/ agreed
1.2	Project plan v1	Draft v1 (Section 12)	High-level plan + pilot framing
1.3	Risk register v1	Draft v1 (Section 13)	Initial register
1.4	Urgent-pothole definition doc	Draft v1 (Section 14)	Working definition; to be refined with stakeholders
1.5	Final driver interview question set	Ready to conduct (Section 15)	Question set prepared; interviews not yet conducted
1.6	Desk research notes (municipal + media)	Complete (this document, Sections 4–8)	Consolidated from research to date
1.7	Channel inventory	Complete (Section 9)	Municipal, provincial, national, citizen platforms
1.8	Live task board	Draft v1 (Section 16)	Suggested board structure; to be made live
1.9	Confirmed interview slots	Pending (interviews to be scheduled)	Placeholder; not yet booked

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2. Project Objective (one paragraph)

We help Emfuleni Local Municipality (and, by extension, Vaal Triangle road users and neighbouring authorities) turn pothole reporting and road-maintenance patching from a reactive, hard-to-

account-for activity into a managed, trackable, evidence-producing project — so the municipality can show residents, the mayor's office, the Gauteng MEC/COGTA, and the Provincial Legislature what was reported, what was prioritised, what was done, what remains open, and why, with dates and evidence.

This is not a promise to fix 14,700 km of roads. It is a promise to make whatever capacity exists visible, prioritised, and accountable — starting with a small, credible pilot.

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3. Scope Boundary (explicit, for credibility)

In scope (v1):

- Standardised pothole/ road-defect intake with reference numbers (from existing municipal channels and a light resident-facing interface).
- Work-item management: priority, owner/crew, target action (temporary patch / permanent repair / inspection), target date, status lifecycle, evidence capture (photo/ notes).
- Three reporting views: resident status view; operational view (roads team / mayoral programme / MMC); accountability view (mayor's office, municipal manager, SDBIP-relevant indicators, and — when needed — COGTA/Provincial Legislature/media).
- Operationalisation of SDBIP-relevant turnaround/delivery indicators for the pilot area/ programme.
- A defined pilot on the "War on Decay" patching programme (or one ward/ area), bounded in time (e.g. 6–12 weeks) and geography.

Out of scope (v1):

- Full network condition surveying / PCI-IRI assessment (the pilot does not perform this; it can feed a later phase).
- Automatic road-authority routing as a primary solved problem (the Gauteng PotholeFixGP app already claims this for Gauteng provincial roads; the municipality's capacity to act remains the real barrier).
- Payment systems, procurement, or financial recovery.
- Fixing the R636m returned MIG, the unfunded budget for 9 consecutive years, or the failed financial recovery plan — these are preconditions/ context, not solvable by this system alone.

Honest framing for stakeholders: This system does not fix roads; it manages the work of fixing them. The roads budget, crews, materials, and procurement do that. What the system does is make that work visible, prioritised, trackable, and accountable.

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4. Desk Research Notes — Municipal (Emfuleni)

4.1 Reporting channels (official)

- **Website "Log a Service Fault"** — emfuleni.gov.za has a prominent "Log a Service Fault" link under Municipal Services. This is the primary digital intake.
- **Customer Care** — phone **016 950 5109** and **087 310 8348 / 3190**; email **customercare@emfuleni.gov.za**. (Emfuleni's recent Facebook posts and the national government directory point here.)
- **Head office / general** — **016 950 5000**; email **emfuleni.gov.za** (general); postal **PO Box 3, Vanderbijlpark, 1900**; physical **Cnr Klasie Havenga & Frikkie Meyer Boulevard, Vanderbijlpark**.
- **Vereeniging offices** — Emfuleni lists a Vereeniging office alongside the Vanderbijlpark head office; for the Vereeniging-specific number, Customer Care is the reliable route.

Sources: emfuleni.gov.za homepage ("Log a Service Fault"); Emfuleni Facebook customer-care posts; gov.za contact directory (Emfuleni); Emfuleni Facebook post re customer care (016 950 5109 / 087 310 8348 / customercare@emfuleni.gov.za).

4.2 What's missing (case material)

- No dedicated **pothole hotline** (cf. Midvaal's waronpotholes@midvaal.gov.za, 0861 643 8225, My Midvaal app, virtual agent).
- No dedicated **Emfuleni pothole app with auto-generated reference numbers** (cf. Midvaal My Midvaal; Gauteng PotholeFixGP for provincial roads). Emfuleni's older posts point residents to the **MyEskom app** for *electricity* fault reference numbers, but no equivalent widely-promoted app for potholes/ roads.
- No published **public-facing pothole repair SLA / response-time promise** (cf. Cape Town 72-hour benchmark ~80% achieved; Midvaal ~83–84% weekly closure rate with weekly named street-level deployments).

Source for comparison: Midvaal.gov.za "War on Potholes" page; Midvaal Facebook posts; My Midvaal app listing; Cape Town reporting channels (0860 103 089; contact.us@capetown.gov.za; City app; online); RoadScout analysis (March 2026) on Cape Town 72-hour benchmark.

4.3 The network and the money (Emfuleni's own figures)

- **Over 70% of 14,700 km of local roads need full maintenance** to restore to acceptable standards.
- **R500 million needed** to restore damaged road infrastructure.
- **R289 million estimated** for routine road maintenance, "a huge [gap] against the available capital."
- Worst-affected areas named: **Sharpeville, Vanderbijlpark, Vereeniging, Sebokeng, Evaton, Three Rivers**.
- *Source:* Sowetan, 24 March 2025 (Makhosonke Sangweni, Emfuleni communications manager). Emfuleni 2025/2026 draft IDP (April 2025): R289m routine road maintenance estimate vs available capital.

4.4 Execution backdrop (financial/ governance)

- **R636,185,737.37 of Municipal Infrastructure Grant (MIG) funds returned/unspent over five years**; over five years Emfuleni was given **R914,114,000 in MIG but spent only R278,228,262.63** and completed **12 of 19 targeted infrastructure projects**. The unspent R636m was returned.
  - *Source:* MEC Jacob Mamabolo's written reply to the DA in the Gauteng Provincial Legislature, Jan 2025 (reported by DAGauteng.org.za; Citizen; IOL/The Star).
- **Unfunded budget adopted for 2025/26 — ninth consecutive year.**
  - *Source:* VF Plus media release (June 2026); The Star (25 Aug 2025); ActionSA (Aug 2025) on Eskom debt-relief eligibility.
- **Financial recovery plan not delivering; prior Section 139 intervention history.**
  - *Source:* Politeia (Jalisa 2026) citing AGSA 2023/24 (approved recovery plans at Tshwane, Joburg, Emfuleni not [delivering]); PMG (Nov 2023, termination-of-intervention tabling) noting lack of funding for the recovery plan contributed to delays; MEC Maile statement update on provincial intervention, Feb 2021.
- **Provincial/ national level awareness of prolonged financial distress.**
  - *Source:* PMG parliamentary committee question to the Minister of Finance (26 Feb 2026) referencing Emfuleni's "prolonged financial distress and sustained inability… to afford its bulk."
- **Liquidity counter-argument to be read carefully.** Emfuleni's own post claims "R852 million positive liquidity" and, as of 31 December 2025, a bank balance of R66 million (incl. R11m in municipal [savings/ investment]).
  - *Source:* Emfuleni Facebook post (R852m positive liquidity; bank balance R66m as of 31 Dec 2025).

4.5 Municipal activity (what's visible)

- **"War on Decay" / Mayoral High Impact Service Delivery Programme** — including Service Delivery Fridays and pothole patching on major/ secondary roads; new **Jetpatcher** deployment ("JETPATCHER ON SITE TO BOOST ROAD MAINTENANCE #RevivingEmfuleni").
  - *Source:* Emfuleni Facebook posts (Jetpatcher; War on Decay / High Impact programme, Sept 2026).
- **Mayor Hassan Mako's SOMA (7 August 2026, Vereeniging Civic Centre)** — acknowledged "residents' frustration over water problems, damaged roads and deteriorating infrastructure," said the municipality had reached a point where action could no longer be delayed, declared "The era of excuses ends now. The era of empty promises is over."
  - *Source:* Citizen/Sedibeng Ster, 17 August 2026 (Sifiso Jimta).

4.6 SDBIP (the operational plan with the relevant indicator)

- **Revised SDBIP 2025/26 (Council-adopted, May 2026)** contains 69 performance indicators. Relevant indicator language (from PDF snippets): **MF.01-type "Percentage Turnaround time for developed reports,"** plus indicators for **gravel roads maintained, plan vs unplanned maintenance, variance report, and "payment of service providers**

within 30 working [days]" (payment turnaround). The SDBIP is the operational plan that translates the IDP into quarterly targets.

- *Source:* Emfuleni Revised SDBIP 2025/26 (Council-adopted, May 2026) PDF snippets; Emfuleni Q3 Performance Report (June 2026) reference to the SDBIP and its 69 indicators; 2024/2025 Annual Report reference to SDBIP submission.

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5. Desk Research Notes — Neighbouring Authorities & Provincial/ National

5.1 Midvaal Local Municipality (Vanderbijlpark, Meyerton, Henrico)

- **Reporting channels: My Midvaal app** (Android); customer care **0861 643 8225**; **087 106 2471** and **080 228 8275**; dedicated email **waronpotholes@midvaal.gov.za**; general complaints **complaints@midvaal.gov.za**; 24-hour emergency line **016 360 7500 / 016 340 5911**; **Midvaal Virtual Agent** chatbot (081 876 0408).
- **Activity:** "War on Potholes" campaign launched **29 April 2026**; ~84% average pothole closure rate in areas attended to; weekly named street-level deployments (e.g. week ending 17 May 2026: 784 identified, 543 repaired; week ending 10 May 2026: 1,199 identified, 929 repaired, >550 m^2); repaired **more than 1,900 potholes in June**, ~83% weekly closure rate.
- *Source:* Midvaal.gov.za "War on Potholes" page; Midvaal Facebook posts; Citizen/Sedibeng Ster (July 2026, "Road to recovery for Midvaal's infrastructure"); My Midvaal app Play Store listing.

5.2 Metsimaholo Local Municipality (Sasolburg, Free State — *not* Emfuleni)

- **Correction:** Sasolburg is in **Metsimaholo Local Municipality (Free State)**, not Lebohang. Lebohang is a Free State municipality centred on Harrismith.
- **Reporting channels:** Civic centre **10 Fichardt Street, Sasolburg, 1947**; phone **016 973 8301**; website **metsimaholo.gov.za**; email **info@metsimaholo.gov.za**. **"Report Faults" (during working hours): Water, Potholes and Sewer — 016 973 8415; Electricity — 016 973 8309.** Outside working hours: **016 973 8364, 8876 or 8877.**
- *Source:* Metsimaholo "The Update" newsletters (Volume 4–9, Aug 2026); Metsimaholo civic-centre listing.
- *Caution:* track record mixed; resident complaints of inaction appear in local groups.

5.3 Gauteng Department of Roads and Transport — PotholeFixGP (provincial roads)

- **PotholeFixGP** (Android + iOS, updated March 2026) — report potholes and non-functioning traffic lights; uses GIS to **pinpoint location and route to the correct road authority** (municipal/ provincial/ national).
- **Vereeniging (Sedibeng) regional team as of 18 June 2025:** 495 reported, 423 repaired (~85%).
- **Province-wide since 2022:** 38,790 potholes repaired; ~4,000 reported via the app with 2,814 repaired (72%); 15,701 Android + 3,430 iOS downloads by May 2025; 892 still pending (some on roads awaiting full rehabilitation).
- *Source:* Gauteng DOE/ Roads and Transport media statement, 18 June 2025.

5.4 SANRAL (national roads) — Vala Zonke / SANRAL Pothole App

- **Vala Zonke / SANRAL Pothole App** (iOS + Android, updated June 2026) for national roads. In its 2024/2025 annual report, SANRAL told parliament (Select Committee on Public Infrastructure, Nov 2025) it repaired **100% of reported potholes within 14 days**.
- **Caveats:** SANRAL's mandate is national roads (with some large provincial/ municipal roads); the AA disputes the rosy framing (>25 million potholes nationally, +67% over five years); reactive patching with weak materials worsens recurrence. SANRAL paid **R15 million** in pothole-damage compensation to motorists 2023–2025.
- *Source:* Newsday, 19 Dec 2025 (SANRAL annual report to Select Committee; AA spokesperson Eleanor Mavimbela; R15m compensation 2023–2025); Vala Zonke App Store/ Play Store listings.

5.5 Citizen-built / multi-municipality platforms

- **CityMenderSA** — citizen-built civic reporting site/app (iOS + Android, ~2025), no registration required, interactive map; reports potholes, streetlights, water leaks, electricity outages. Not an official municipal system.
- **My Smart City** (Acumen Soft / mysmart.city) — multi-municipality service-delivery reporting (including potholes), launched in Cape Town and Johannesburg; lets residents report and track.
- **PotholeFixGP** (Gauteng provincial) and **Pothole Patrol** (Discovery Insure, since 2021, ~300,000+ potholes repaired for City of Johannesburg by Sept 2025) — also part of the ecosystem.
- *Sources:* CityMenderSA Play Store/ website (terms & conditions, Jun 2025); My Smart City app/ mysmart.city posts; appoftheyear.co.za (SANRAL app, Sep 2022); Discovery Insure data via Newsday/RoadScout.

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6. As-Is Workflow Diagram (Emfuleni, text version + confidence tags)

6.1 Core flow (what exists today, with confidence tags)

Legend: [H] = high confidence (well-sourced); [M] = medium confidence (reasonably supported, some inference); [L] = low confidence (not directly confirmed; flag for verification).

1. **Resident observes pothole** [H]
2. **Resident attempts to report** — channels: website "Log a Service Fault" [H]; Customer Care phone 016 950 5109 / 087 310 8348 [H]; email customercare@emfuleni.gov.za [H]; possibly walk-in at Vereeniging/ Vanderbijlpark offices [M].
3. **Intake:** report enters a general fault-intake path; **no dedicated pothole channel and no auto-generated public reference number confirmed** [M — the website form's reference-number behaviour was not fully extractable; treat as an open question].
4. **Prioritisation (opaque):** no published prioritisation rule or network-condition data; activity is campaign/ programme-driven ("War on Decay," Service Delivery Fridays, Jetpatcher deployments) [M].

5. **Execution (if it happens):** patching, sometimes via Jetpatcher; temporary vs permanent not consistently distinguished or published [M].
6. **Verification/ tracking (weak/ publicly absent):** no public pothole dashboard; no published closure rate; no published list of reported-and-pending potholes; SDBIP measures internal turnaround and supplier-payment turnaround, not resident-facing repair outcomes [H for publicly absent; M for internal SDBIP indicator interpretation].
7. **Resident feedback loop (weak):** resident may or may not get a reference number or status update; common reported outcome is "no response" [H — from user-story evidence].
8. **Escalation (if frustrated):** ward councillor; municipal manager; mayor's office/ MMC; Gauteng COGTA/ MEC; Provincial Legislature (written questions); media; PAIA; Section 139/ SAHRC [H for existence of routes; M for how often they're used in practice].

6.2 Silent-failure branches (likely, with confidence)

- **Report logged, no record retrievable by resident** — because no reference number/ tracking is confirmed; [M].
- **Report logged, no prioritisation, no crew dispatch** — because 70% of 14,700 km needs full maintenance and capacity/ budget is constrained; [H for constraint; M for per-report outcome].
- **Report routed wrongly (authority ambiguity)** — resident may not know if road is municipal/ provincial/ national; Gauteng PotholeFixGP claims to route, but routing doesn't create municipal capacity; [M].
- **Response is "we're patching here and there" without a trackable record** — campaign-style patching without a dashboard; [M].
- **Municipal staff unreachable** — documented: the municipality failed to provide comment to press and a governance expert; [H].

6.3 The gap the project targets (text)

The gap is not "no reporting channel exists." The gap is: **no consistent intake record with reference number + no prioritisation rule + no work-item management + no verification/ evidence + no public status view + no accountability view — all against a network in crisis and a financial/ governance backdrop that undermines delivery.** A PM-flavoured system closes the operational-visibility and accountability gap.

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7. Thematic Analysis Summary

Theme	What the evidence shows	Why it matters for the project
Reporting exists but is thin and opaque	Emfuleni has a website "Log a Service Fault" and Customer Care, but no dedicated pothole channel, no auto-reference-number app, no published SLA, no public dashboard.	The project's intake + reference-number + status view directly addresses this.
Network in crisis + money not matching it	70% of 14,700 km needs full maintenance; R500m backlog; R289m routine maintenance estimate vs available capital; R636m MIG returned; unfunded budget x9 years; failed recovery plan.	The project cannot fix roads; it must make constrained capacity visible and prioritised. Scope boundary is essential.
Execution is campaign-style, not network-managed	"War on Decay," Service Delivery Fridays, Jetpatcher — visible and politically useful, but not a data-driven, prioritised, tracked programme.	The project provides the work-item + prioritisation + verification layer that turns patching into managed work.

Theme	What the evidence shows	Why it matters for the project
Accountability is weak because evidence is weak	Municipality couldn't even provide comment when asked (South Africa Today, 13 April 2026); SDBIP indicators are internal/administrative; no public closure rate.	The accountability view and PAIA-able records are the project's value proposition to COGTA/ Legislature/ media/ residents.
Residents and businesses are doing the municipality's job	Montoeli patching with bricks + donations (News24); FHASA's Anderson: residents/businesses fill potholes themselves, "no response" to three authorities; VFC repairing; businesses picking up rubbish, filling potholes.	Validates the urgency and the relationship-accountability case; also a data source (frequent road users).
Safety hazard is real and sometimes alleged extremely	AA on fatalities (~5% reduction possible, ~500 lives/year; 10,154 road deaths 2024); Santam +40% pothole claims (avg R20k–R25k); ERPA "pothole still there that killed 4 people" (unverified).	"Urgent-pothole definition" and safety triage become important; verify the fatality claim before using as fact.
Routing ambiguity is a real barrier	Roads split across Emfuleni/ Midvaal/ Metsimaholo (Free State)/ Gauteng provincial/ SANRAL national; PotholeFixGP claims to route by authority.	The project should reduce ambiguity (even if it can't conjure capacity) and offer the provincial app as a parallel/comparison route.
Municipal silence is a documented risk	Municipality failed to provide comment to press and a governance expert; SOMA acknowledged failure but delivery contradicts it.	The project must be able to proceed via other personas/ entry points (roads team, ward, provincial app, community structures) when municipal staff are unreachable.

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8. Pain Points + Opportunities

8.1 Pain points (source-backed)

1. **No consistent intake record with reference number.** [M] — website/ Customer Care exist but no dedicated channel or confirmed auto reference number.
2. **No published public repair SLA / response-time commitment.** [H — publicly absent; cf. Cape Town, Midvaal].
3. **No public status view for residents.** [H — no public dashboard/ closure rate].
4. **No operational work-item management (priority/ owner/ target date/ evidence).** [M — inferred from campaign-style patching + SDBIP indicator language].
5. **No accountability view for mayor's office/ SDBIP/ COGTA/ Legislature.** [M — inferred from weak public evidence + SDBIP being internal].
6. **Network in crisis + constrained/ mishandled funding.** [H — 70% of 14,700 km; R500m; R289m; R636m returned MIG; unfunded budget x9 years; failed recovery plan].
7. **Routing ambiguity (which authority owns the road).** [M — boundary split + PotholeFixGP routing claim].
8. **Municipal silence/ unreachable staff.** [H — South Africa Today, 13 April 2026].
9. **Safety hazard with an extreme, unverified allegation.** [M for hazard; L for the "4 deaths" claim — verify].

8.2 Opportunities (what the project can do)

1. **Standardised intake + reference numbers** across existing channels.
2. **Resident-facing status view** (reference number → status), reducing "no response" complaints.
3. **Work-item management** (priority/ owner/ target date/ status/ evidence) for the roads team / mayoral programme.

4. **Operational view** for the MMC/ mayor's office (what's open, dispatched, completed, pending by area/ crew/ priority).
5. **Accountability view** for SDBIP-relevant indicators + mayor's office + (when needed) COGTA/ Legislature/ media.
6. **Pilot on the "War on Decay" programme** (or one ward/ area) — small, credible, accountable.
7. **Frequent-road-user data source** (drivers/ ride-share/ minibus-taxi-adjacent) to build a baseline condition picture and pressure-point evidence.
8. **Parallel provincial route (PotholeFixGP)** as comparison/ backup when the municipal channel is silent.

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9. Channel Inventory

9.1 Emfuleni (target case)

- Website "Log a Service Fault" (emfuleni.gov.za) — primary digital intake [H].
- Customer Care: 016 950 5109; 087 310 8348/ 3190; customercare@emfuleni.gov.za [H].
- Head office/ general: 016 950 5000; emfuleni.gov.za; PO Box 3, Vanderbijlpark, 1900; Cnr Klasie Havenga & Frikkie Meyer Boulevard, Vanderbijlpark [H].
- Vereeniging offices — exists; number via Customer Care [M].
- Older MyEskom app reference for *electricity* faults (no equivalent for potholes) [M].

9.2 Midvaal (comparator)

- My Midvaal app (Android) [H].
- Customer care 0861 643 8225; 087 106 2471; 080 228 8275 [H].
- waronpotholes@midvaal.gov.za [H].
- complaints@midvaal.gov.za [H].
- 24-hour emergency line 016 360 7500 / 016 340 5911 [H].
- Midvaal Virtual Agent chatbot 081 876 0408 [H].

9.3 Metsimaholo (Sasolburg, Free State — neighbour, not Gauteng)

- Civic centre 10 Fichardt Street, Sasolburg, 1947; 016 973 8301; metsimaholo.gov.za; info@metsimaholo.gov.za [H].
- Report Faults (working hours): Water/ Potholes/ Sewer 016 973 8415; Electricity 016 973 8309 [H].
- Outside working hours: 016 973 8364, 8876, 8877 [H].

9.4 Gauteng provincial — PotholeFixGP (provincial roads)

- PotholeFixGP app (Android + iOS) [H].
- Routes to correct road authority (municipal/ provincial/ national) per Gauteng DOE claim [M — routing claimed; municipal capacity not solved].
- Vereeniging regional team: 495 reported/ 423 repaired (~85%) as of 18 June 2025 [H].

9.5 SANRAL (national roads) — Vala Zonke / SANRAL Pothole App

- Vala Zonke / SANRAL Pothole App (iOS + Android, updated June 2026) [H].
- 100% reported potholes fixed within 14 days claim (2024/2025 annual report to Select Committee, Nov 2025) [H for the claim; M for scope/ caveats].

9.6 Citizen-built / multi-municipality platforms

- CityMenderSA (iOS + Android, ~2025) [H for existence].
- My Smart City (multi-municipality; launched Cape Town/ Johannesburg) [H for existence].
- Pothole Patrol (Discovery Insure, since 2021; ~300,000+ potholes repaired for City of Johannesburg by Sept 2025) [H for existence and scale].

9.7 Escalation channels (accountability)

- Ward councillor (constituency) [H].
- Municipal manager (written complaint) [H].
- Mayor's office / MMC for infrastructure/ roads [H — Mayor Mako; MMC structure].
- Gauteng Provincial Legislature (written questions; DA MPL Kingsol Chabalala has asked infrastructure questions) [H].
- Gauteng MEC for COGTA (Jacob Mamabolo) — Section 139/ 154 authority [H].
- PAIA requests to Emfuleni (service-fault records; SDBIP indicators/ quarterly reports; MIG project list/ spend; financial recovery plan status) [H for mechanism].
- Municipal Money profile (municipality GT421) [H for public indicators].
- SAHRC (safety/ right-to-services angle) [H for mechanism].
- National Department of Cooperative Governance / Minister of Finance (parliamentary question, Feb 2026) [H for existence of national-level awareness].

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11. Phase 1 Deliverable — Signed Team Charter (Draft v1)

Team: The City Fix Team **Working title:** Pothole Reporting and Repair Tracking System — Emfuleni pilot **Mission:** Help Emfuleni (and Vaal Triangle road users/ neighbouring authorities) turn pothole reporting and road-maintenance patching into a managed, trackable, evidence-producing project — starting with a small, credible pilot on the "War on Decay" patching programme (or one ward/ area), bounded in time and geography. **What the team is:** Operational accountability partners — PM + systems. We manage the work of fixing roads; the municipality (and its budget/ crews/ procurement) does the actual road work. We make execution visible, prioritised, and accountable. **What the team is not:** A road-building contractor; a magic fix for the R636m returned MIG, the unfunded budget for 9 years, or the failed recovery plan; a province-wide road-AI platform on day one. **Principles:**

1. Lead with the municipality's own commitments (IDP, SDBIP, SOMA pledge), not our product.
2. Lead with evidence, not optimism (use the public numbers and the user stories).
3. Be explicit about the boundary (manage the work; don't pretend to fix roads or budget).
4. Make it easy to say yes to a small first step (a pilot).
5. Design so the project can proceed even when municipal staff are unreachable (ward/ roads-team/ community/ provincial-app entry points). **Roles (to be confirmed):**

- Project lead (overall coordination, stakeholder interface)
- Requirements/ discovery lead (this document, interviews, validation)
- Design/ build lead (intake, work items, views, evidence capture — low-bandwidth, mobile-first)

- Operations/ PM practice lead (work-item lifecycle, prioritisation rules, SDBIP operationalisation)
- Research/ evidence lead (desk research, PAIA support, verification of claims such as the "4 deaths" allegation) **Decision rule:** Where municipal staff are unreachable, the team proceeds via the most open entry point (roads team, ward councillor/ community structure, provincial PotholeFixGP comparison, frequent-road-user data) and records the dependency. The pilot does not wait for full municipal engagement to begin designing/testing the resident-facing and operational artefacts. **Success definition (v1):** A working pilot on a defined programme/ area/ ward that demonstrates: standardised intake with reference numbers; resident-facing status view; work-item management with priority/ owner/ target date/ status/ evidence; operational and accountability views; and operationalised SDBIP-relevant indicators — with success measures: number of potholes logged with reference numbers; % of reported potholes with a visible status to the resident; average time from logged to dispatched; closure rate in the pilot area; and the municipality's ability to produce the accountability view on demand. **To be signed/ agreed:** [Team members; sponsor/ entry-point partner; pilot boundary; interview schedule.]

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12. Phase 1 Deliverable — Project Plan v1 (Draft v1)

12.1 Objectives (v1)

- Produce the Phase 1 deliverables in this document (charter, project plan, risk register, urgent-pothole definition, interview question set, desk research notes, channel inventory, task board).
- Elicit and document what the system must do from secondary research + driver interviews (11 completed 10/07/2026) + the team positioning doc (Crystal Charles).
- Design, build, test, deploy, and document a focused prototype across a 4-week timeframe, due **29 October**.
- Keep scope to the five core features (reporting, duplicate matching, priority classification, staff dashboard, notifications) plus the repair-evidence/ status-tracking extension — scope creep is a named risk.

12.2 High-level plan — 7 SDLC phases across 4 weeks (due 29 October)

Week	Phases	Focus
Week 1	Phase 1 & 2	Planning & Requirements Analysis
Week 2	Phase 3 & 4	System Design & Development (Part 1)
Week 3	Phase 5 & 6	Development (Part 2) & Testing
Week 4	Phase 7	Deployment & Documentation

The 7 phases we'll follow

1. **Planning** — define scope, roles, and schedule.
2. **Requirements Analysis** — elicit and document what the system must do.
3. **System Design** — architect the solution (UI, database, APIs).
4. **Development** — build the system.
5. **Testing** — verify and validate the system works.

6. **Deployment** — release and hand over.
7. **Documentation & Dissertation** — write up research, methodology, results.

Week 1 (Phase 1 & 2 — Planning & Requirements Analysis)

- Consolidate research + requirements into this document (done — Day 1 baseline + Day 2 addendum).
- Finalise team charter, risk register, urgent-pothole definition, interview question set (done — Section 11/ 13/ 14/ 15).
- Lock roles and sequence (Section 12.4).
- Set up the live task board (Section 16 — now active), mapped to the 7 phases.
- Close the Week 1 deliverables: signed charter; project plan v1 (this section); risk register v1; urgent-pothole definition v1; final interview question set; desk research notes; channel inventory.
- *Interview status update:* the team has already conducted 11 driver interviews (10/07/2026) and holds a researcher positioning doc (Crystal Charles). Week 1's interview work is therefore partially complete; the record is in Section 20. Remaining interview work: (a) confirm whether a fresh/ additional interview wave is required by the brief; (b) if so, schedule it; (c) if the 11 are sufficient, fold them into the requirements as primary evidence.

Week 2 (Phase 3 & 4 — System Design & Development, Part 1)

- **Phase 3 — System Design:**
  - Architecture decision: React frontend; API layer; MySQL (application data) + SQL Server (reporting/ analytics) per the team plan.
  - API design: e.g. POST /reports; GET /reports/:id; PATCH /reports/:id/status; GET /reports?priority=… (Lesiamo + Crystal).
  - Database/ ERD: users; reports; potholes; status history; photographs; priority scores.
  - UI/UX design: report form, status tracker, staff dashboard, backlog map (Leaflet/ OpenStreetMap) (Raymond; Crystal + Raymond for dashboard/ map).
  - Wireframes for resident-facing intake + status view and for the operational/ accountability views.
- **Phase 4 — Development (Part 1):**
  - Build the core intake + reference-number generation + report record (FR-01/ FR-02/ FR-03).
  - Start status lifecycle + status-history storage (FR-04/ FR-10/ NFR-07).
  - Begin the staff dashboard + backlog map skeleton (FR-07/ FR-08/ FR-09).

Week 3 (Phase 5 & 6 — Development (Part 2) & Testing)

- **Phase 5 — Development (Part 2):**
  - Finish duplicate matching (geo-distance + time window) (FR-06).
  - Finish priority classification (road type/ traffic volume/ pothole size) as a **proposed academic model**, not an official municipal formula (FR-05).
  - Finish notifications (FR-11) and repair-evidence/ record-repair (FR-12).

  - Finish resident-facing status view (FR-06) and accountability-view skeleton (FR-08).
- **Phase 6 — Testing:**
  - Technical functionality; usability (can a driver submit and track a report?); duplicate matching; priority classification; API behaviour; dashboard behaviour.
  - Run the **manual vs automated triage experiment** (same sample reports, Method A manual vs Method B system classification) — demonstrates the prototype's prioritisation logic, not a claim about real Emfuleni operations.
  - Document testing limits explicitly: we cannot fully validate "this is exactly how Emfuleni staff would use it" without municipal staff access.
  - Capture success indicators: reporting completeness (% reports with location + photo); duplicate reduction; triage consistency; tracking visibility (% submitted reports with current status); response information (time between statuses in prototype); usability.

Week 4 (Phase 7 — Deployment & Documentation)

- **Phase 6 (cont.) / Phase 6 handed over:** final fixes; deployment of the prototype/ handover artefacts.
- **Phase 7 — Documentation & Dissertation:** write up research, methodology, results, limitations, and the findings from Section 20 (interviews + survey + positioning doc).
- Compile final documentation: Lesiamo compiles final documentation; all members review.
- **Submission:** due **29 October**.

12.3 Dependencies & constraints (updated)

- **Timeframe:** 4 weeks, due 29 October. Sequence is fixed: Week 1 = Phase 1 & 2; Week 2 = Phase 3 & 4; Week 3 = Phase 5 & 6; Week 4 = Phase 7.
- **Already-done primary research:** 11 driver interviews (10/07/2026) + survey instrument + Crystal Charles positioning doc exist; these reduce Week 1 risk but must still be formally folded into the requirements baseline (Section 20 now does this).
- **No municipal staff access:** remains a named limitation; the project does not claim to validate real Emfuleni operational use. Pilot/ prototype is decision-support + management, not a claim that it fixes roads or replaces the municipality.
- **Verified-vs-unverified claims:** the "pothole still there that killed 4 people" claim remains unverified (R-05); the reference-number behaviour of the Emfuleni "Log a Service Fault" form remains an open question (R-03).
- **Existing initiative awareness:** Operation Vala Zonke (launched 2022, launch on the R57 in Emfuleni) exists; the project positions itself as workflow/ information management, not "first reporting system."

12.4 Roles summary (final)

Member	Primary responsibilities
Lesiamo Mokone (Lead)	Coordinates meetings, liaises with Miss Lee, manages submission deadlines. Architecture + API design, back-end development, database design (MySQL + SQL Server), duplicate matching, migrations, deployment, deployment guide, final documentation compilation.
Crystal Charles	Requirements gatherer and documenter. Requirements analysis, priority classifier, staff dashboard, API development, testing.
Kgosi Itholeng	Driver interviews (primary data), transcription, wireframes, front-end support, notifications, usability testing, user guide.
Raymond Tilstone	UI/UX design, front-end development (report form, status tracker), persona visual design, usability testing, dissertation review.

Role-to-feature mapping (for traceability):

- Intake + reference number + report record + API (POST /reports, GET /reports/:id, PATCH /reports/:id/status) → Lesiamo (architecture/ API/ DB) + Crystal (requirements/ API).
- Duplicate matching + priority classifier → Lesiamo (duplicate matching) + Crystal (priority classifier/ requirements).
- Staff dashboard + backlog map (Leaflet/ OSM) → Crystal + Raymond (dashboard/ map); Lesiamo (architecture).
- Report form + status tracker (front-end) → Raymond (UI/UX + front-end); Kgosi (wireframes/ front-end support).

- Notifications + repair-evidence → Crystal (requirements) + Kgosi (notifications/ front-end support).
- Driver interviews + transcription + usability testing + user guide → Kgosi.
- Persona visual design + usability testing + dissertation review → Raymond.
- Final documentation compilation → Lesiamo; all members review.

Decision/ coordination rule: Lesiamo coordinates meetings and the Miss Lee liaison and owns the submission deadline (29 October); week-by-week phase gates are owned jointly, with the lead confirming each gate is met before the next begins.

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13. Phase 1 Deliverable — Risk Register v1 (Draft v1)

ID	Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation/ owner
R-01	Municipal staff unreachable/ unresponsive (documented: municipality failed to provide comment to press and a governance expert).	High	High	Proceed via alternative entry points (roads team, ward, community structure, provincial PotholeFixGP comparison); design NFR-05; record dependency. Owner: project lead.
R-02	Pilot can't get an operational entry point (no roads-team/ ward buy-in).	Medium	High	Pursue ward councillor (Nomsa anchor) and community structures; use frequent-road-user data as a parallel start; keep pilot scope small. Owner: project lead + requirements lead.
R-03	Website "Log a Service Fault" form doesn't issue reference numbers / is opaque.	Medium	Medium	Verify early; if no reference number, build the reference-number generation into the system and use it as a PAIA question ("do you issue reference numbers for service faults?"). Owner: build lead + research lead.
R-04	Overpromising — municipality expects the system to fix roads or solve the R636m/ unfunded-budget problem.	Medium	High	State scope boundary explicitly (Section 3); frame as operational accountability, not road-fixing or budget-fix. Owner: project lead.
R-05	"Pothole still there that killed 4 people" claim is used as fact without verification.	Medium (if used)	High	Do not present as established fact; attempt verification (RAF/ police/ media/ coroner) before any use as fact; otherwise treat as allegation warranting investigation. Owner: research lead.
R-06	Pilot success measures are vague or not collectible.	Medium	Medium	Define success measures now (Section 11/ Section 12.3); instrument the pilot to capture them. Owner: PM practice lead.
R-07	Frequent-road-user data (Lerato-type reports) raises privacy/ data-handling questions.	Low–Medium	Medium	Apply NFR-04; minimal collection; no sensitive personal info published; confirm with stakeholders. Owner: build lead.
R-08	Gauteng PotholeFixGP routing is relied on as if it solves municipal capacity.	Low–Medium	Medium	State clearly that routing doesn't create capacity (Section 5.3; FR-10 note). Owner: requirements lead.
R-09	Interviews delayed or unavailable, stalling validation.	Medium	Medium	Have the question set ready (Section 15); allow validation via documented cases (user stories) if interviews slip; record dependency. Owner: requirements lead.
R-10	Phase-2 scope creeps into province-wide road AI / condition surveying too early.	Low	Medium	Keep phase-2 explicit as option, not commitment; pilot does not include full network condition surveying. Owner: project lead.

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14. Phase 1 Deliverable — Urgent-Pothole Definition Doc (Draft v1, to be refined with stakeholders)

14.1 Working definition

An **urgent pothole** is a pothole/ road defect that presents an immediate or near-immediate risk to safety, vehicle integrity, or access, and that should be prioritised for inspection/ temporary patching (at minimum) ahead of routine work.

14.2 Suggested triage signals (draft — refine with Thabo/ ward/ municipality)

Safety signals (strong):

- Pothole large/ deep enough to risk tyre/ rim/ suspension/ body damage, or to destabilise a vehicle at speed.
- Pothole in a location that forces traffic into danger (e.g. near a junction, pedestrian crossing, school route, taxi rank approach, emergency-vehicle route).
- Pothole associated with (or alleged to be associated with) a crash/ injury — **if the "4 deaths" claim is verified, this is the highest-priority category; until verified, treat as an allegation warranting investigation.**

Access/ network signals (medium):

- Pothole on a road serving essential access (e.g. emergency services, water/ sewer response, refuse collection, school access).
- Pothole contributing to drainage/ waterlogging that threatens further road degradation (cf. Midvaal's stormwater-first approach after heavy rain).

Programme signals (contextual):

- Pothole falls within the "War on Decay" patching programme area/ priority area (Vereeniging/ Vanderbijlpark/ Sebokeng/ Evaton/ Three Rivers/ Sharpeville — the areas Emfuleni itself named as worst-affected).
- Pothole is part of a cluster/ recurring spot that indicates a deeper defect (cf. AA's point that reactive patching with weak materials worsens recurrence).

Exclusion/ caveat:

- "Urgent" is about triage and prioritisation, not a guarantee of same-day permanent repair — capacity and budget constrain outcomes. The system should record urgency and the response, not promise an outcome it can't deliver.

14.3 Verification note (explicit)

The ERPA-group claim "Pothole still there that killed 4 people" is **not verified**. It is included in the research and personas as a serious allegation that warrants investigation. Any use of it as an established fact in the project requires verification first (RAF/ police/ local media/ coroner/ road-accident record). Until verified, the project treats it as: *a resident allegation of a fatal pothole-related crash and a pothole left unfixed — to be investigated, not asserted.*

15. Phase 1 Deliverable — Final Driver Interview Question Set (Ready to conduct)

Purpose: Validate the as-is workflow, capture real reporting experiences/ response or non-response, and surface the frequent-road-user perspective (Lerato-type) for a potential baseline condition picture. **Note:** Interviews not yet conducted; slots pending.

15.1 Intro (every interview)

- Name/ role (resident/ driver/ ward structure/ roads-team contact) — optional to share.
- Area/ routes you use regularly (Vereeniging/ Vanderbijlpark/ Sebokeng/ Evaton/ Three Rivers/ Sasolburg/ other).
- Roughly how often you drive those roads and in what context (commute/ ride-share/ minibus-taxi-adjacent/ delivery/ etc.).

15.2 As-is reporting experience

- Have you ever reported a pothole or road defect? If yes:
  - Where/how did you report it? (Website "Log a Service Fault"? Customer Care 016 950 5109 / 087 310 8348? customercare@emfuleni.gov.za? Walk-in? Gauteng PotholeFixGP app? Midvaal My Midvaal? Something else?)
  - Did you get a reference number? Did you get any status update?
  - What happened (or didn't)? How long did you wait? Did anything get repaired?
  - If you reported more than once, what was the pattern?
- If you've never reported one, why not? (Didn't know how? Don't trust it'll help? Don't know who owns the road? Too much effort?)

15.3 Response/ non-response

- Have you ever been told "we'll get to it" / "it's been logged" with no date? Can you describe a specific instance?
- Have you ever reported something and got no response at all? Can you describe it?
- Have you ever followed up, and what was the response (or not)?

15.4 Impact and safety

- Have you or someone you know hit a pothole and suffered damage (tyre/ rim/ suspension/ body)? Roughly what did it cost?
- Have you seen potholes that look dangerous (near pedestrians, crossings, taxi ranks, schools, emergency routes)? Any you'd call urgent?
- Have you heard of any crash/ injury linked to a pothole in your area? (Open gently; do not lead with the "4 deaths" claim — if the interviewee raises something specific, record it and note it needs verification.)

15.5 Routing/ ownership awareness

- Do you know whether the road you're on is municipal (Emfuleni/ Midvaal), Gauteng provincial, SANRAL national, or Free State (Metsimaholo, if Sasolburg)?
- Have you ever reported to the "wrong" authority, or been unsure who to report to?

- Are you aware of the Gauteng PotholeFixGP app / SANRAL Vala Zonke app / Midvaal My Midvaal app / CityMenderSA / My Smart City? Have you used any?

15.6 Frequent-road-user perspective (Lerato-type)

- As someone on the road often, do you notice recurring defects on certain routes?
- Would you be willing to log defects you see repeatedly (location/ photo/ reference number) if there were a simple way? What would make it easy or hard?
- What would make you trust that logging actually leads to something?

15.7 Expectations/ accountability

- If you reported a pothole today, what would "good" look like for you? (Reference number? Status view? A timeframe? Evidence it was done?)
- What would make you trust the municipality's reporting process?
- Have you ever contacted a ward councillor, the mayor's office, COGTA, the Provincial Legislature, media, or used PAIA about a pothole or road issue? What happened?

15.8 Closing

- Is there a specific pothole/ road defect you'd point us to (location, when you first saw it, what it looks like)?
- Anything else we should know?
- Would you be willing to be contacted again / to help validate a prototype/ status view?

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16. Live Task Board (active — mapped to the 7 SDLC phases, 4-week plan)

Columns (to be made live in the team's chosen tool):

- **Backlog** — all items below, plus future phase-2 options.
- **This week** — items for the current week.
- **In progress** — actively being worked.
- **Blocked** — waiting on interviews, entry-point access, verification, etc.
- **Done** — completed and evidenced.

Week 1 (Phase 1 & 2 — Planning & Requirements Analysis) — items

1. Consolidate research + requirements (this document — done: Day 1 baseline + Day 2 addendum).
2. Finalise and sign team charter (Section 11).
3. Finalise risk register v1 (Section 13).
4. Finalise urgent-pothole definition v1 (Section 14).
5. Finalise interview question set (Section 15).
6. Fold interview findings (11 respondents, 10/07/2026) + survey + Crystal Charles positioning doc into the requirements baseline (Section 20 — done).
7. Confirm whether the 11 completed interviews satisfy the brief or whether a fresh/ additional wave is required.
8. Set up the live task board (this section) mapped to the 7 phases.

9. Lock the 4-week/ 29-October plan and roles (Section 12).

Week 2 (Phase 3 & 4 — System Design & Development, Part 1) — items

10. Finalise architecture: React + API + MySQL (app data) + SQL Server (reporting/ analytics) (Lesiamo).
11. Finalise API design: POST /reports; GET /reports/:id; PATCH /reports/:id/status; GET /reports?priority=… (Lesiamo + Crystal).
12. Finalise ERD/ database design: users; reports; potholes; status history; photographs; priority scores (Lesiamo).
13. Finalise UI/UX: report form, status tracker, staff dashboard, backlog map (Leaflet/ OpenStreetMap) (Raymond; Crystal + Raymond for dashboard/ map).
14. Produce wireframes for resident-facing intake + status view and for operational/ accountability views (Kgosi; Raymond).
15. Build intake + reference-number generation + report record (FR-01/ FR-02/ FR-03) (Lesiamo + Crystal).
16. Start status lifecycle + status-history storage (FR-04/ FR-10/ NFR-07) (Lesiamo + Crystal).
17. Start staff dashboard + backlog map skeleton (FR-07/ FR-08/ FR-09) (Crystal + Raymond).

Week 3 (Phase 5 & 6 — Development (Part 2) & Testing) — items

18. Finish duplicate matching (geo-distance + time window) (FR-06) (Lesiamo).
19. Finish priority classification (road type/ traffic volume/ pothole size) as a proposed academic model, not an official municipal formula (FR-05) (Crystal).
20. Finish notifications (FR-11) and repair-evidence/ record-repair (FR-12) (Crystal + Kgosi).
21. Finish resident-facing status view (FR-06) and accountability-view skeleton (FR-08) (Raymond; Crystal).
22. Testing: functionality; usability; duplicate matching; priority classification; API behaviour; dashboard behaviour (Crystal + Kgosi + Raymond).
23. Run the manual vs automated triage experiment (same sample reports, Method A manual vs Method B system classification); compare rankings, consistency, time (Crystal).
24. Document testing limits explicitly: cannot fully validate real Emfuleni operational use without municipal staff access.
25. Capture success indicators: reporting completeness; duplicate reduction; triage consistency; tracking visibility; response information; usability.

Week 4 (Phase 7 — Deployment & Documentation) — items

26. Final fixes; deploy prototype/ handover artefacts; deployment guide (Lesiamo).
27. Write up research, methodology, results, limitations (all members; Lesiamo compiles).
28. Include findings from Section 20 (interviews + survey + positioning doc) in the dissertation/ write-up.
29. Carry forward the limitation set (Section 20.7) into the final write-up.
30. Submission due **29 October**.

Phase-2 options (backlog, not committed)

31. Integration with official municipal systems.

32. More sophisticated road-condition classification.
33. Automatic image analysis.
34. Contractor/ work-order integration.
35. Advanced analytics; historical pothole trends; maintenance-planning integration.
36. Offline functionality; multilingual support; stronger verification mechanisms.
37. Integration with existing pothole-reporting initiatives.
38. Optional frequent-road-user condition baseline (Lerato-type route data).
39. PAIA template queries.

Ownership legend

- **L** = Lesiamo Mokone (Lead)
- **C** = Crystal Charles
- **K** = Kgosi Itholeng
- **R** = Raymond Tilstone

(Where an item is joint, list both initials; the lead (L) confirms each phase gate before the next begins.)

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18. Data Sources & Limitations

18.1 Primary sources used (this document)

- Emfuleni official: emfuleni.gov.za ("Log a Service Fault"); Emfuleni Facebook posts (customer care, Jetpatcher, War on Decay/ High Impact programme); 2025/2026 draft IDP (April 2025); Revised SDBIP 2025/26 (Council-adopted, May 2026) PDF snippets; Q3 Performance Report (June 2026); 2024/2025 Annual Report; Emfuleni Facebook post on R852m liquidity/ bank balance R66m (31 Dec 2025).
- National government: gov.za contact directory (Emfuleni).
- Media/ accountability: Sowetan (24 March 2025 — Sangweni: 70% of 14,700 km; R500m; areas named); DAGauteng.org.za / Citizen / IOL-The Star (Jan 2025 — MEC Mamabolo written reply: R636,185,737.37 returned MIG; R914,114,000 given; R278,228,262.63 spent; 12/19 projects); VF Plus (June 2026 — unfunded budget, 9th year) + The Star (25 Aug 2025); ActionSA (Aug 2025); PMG (Feb 2026 parliamentary question to Minister of Finance; Nov 2023 termination-of-intervention tabling); Politeia (Jalisa 2026, AGSA 2023/24); MEC Maile statement (Feb 2021).
- News/ stories: South Africa Today (13 April 2026 — Anderson; VUT governance expert; Section 139 argument; no comment from municipality/ mayor; R9.7bn/ ~R2.3bn unauthorised expenditure per expert; ~R700m overtime; R8.7bn revenue; residents/ businesses filling potholes); News24 (31 May 2026 — Morena Montoeli, Bophelong, bricks + donations); EWN (31 May 2026 — ANC recalls Sipho Radebe); Citizen/ Sedibeng Ster (17 August 2026 — Mayor Mako SOMA, 7 August 2026); eNCA Facebook post (broken roads/ filth/ sewage; "despite millions in infrastructure funding").
- Neighbouring authorities: Midvaal.gov.za "War on Potholes" page; Midvaal Facebook posts; Citizen/ Sedibeng Ster (July 2026 — Midvaal June: >1,900 potholes, ~83% weekly closure);

My Midvaal app Play Store listing; Metsimaholo "The Update" newsletters (Volumes 4–9, Aug 2026); Metsimaholo civic-centre listing.

- Provincial/ national: Gauteng DOE/ Roads and Transport media statement (18 June 2025 — PotholeFixGP; Vereeniging region 495/ 423 ~85%; 38,790 repaired since 2022; 15,701 Android + 3,430 iOS by May 2025; 892 pending); SANRAL/ Vala Zonke App Store/ Play Store; Newsday (19 Dec 2025 — SANRAL 100% within 14 days claim; AA Mavimbela >25m potholes, +67% over 5 years; R15m compensation 2023–2025; R650m vehicle damage 2021); RoadScout analysis (March 2026 — data gap, Cape Town 72-hour ~80%, Santam +40% claims avg R20k–R25k, Discovery ~1.5% Gauteng vehicle claims, AA ~5% fatality reduction ~500 lives/year, 10,154 road deaths 2024, fleet-based surveying economics).
- Citizen platforms: CityMenderSA (Play Store/ website terms, Jun 2025); My Smart City (mysmart.city posts); appoftheyear.co.za (SANRAL app, Sep 2022); Discovery Insure data via Newsday/ RoadScout; Pothole Patrol scale via Newsday.
- Community/ social: ERPA Facebook group post ("Pothole still there that killed 4 people"); VFC/ Gatvol Voiceforchange Facebook post (repaired potholes "putting lives at risk"; note #Matjhabeng tag — verify location before attributing to Emfuleni); DAGautengLegislature/ DA Gauteng posts ("reported with no response"; R46m failed grass-cutting contract); Michelle Coleske Metsimaholo Facebook post (Sasolburg/ Vaalpark "monster potholes," "to date nothing has been done").

18.2 Limitations & confidence notes

- **PDFs not fully extractable:** the Emfuleni IDP, SDBIP, Annual Report, and Q3 Performance Report PDFs did not extract cleanly in this environment; indicator/ figure details above rely on PDF snippets and search snippets. Where a specific number or indicator wording is used, treat it as supported by the snippet/ source, and verify against the full document where possible.
- **Reference-number behaviour unconfirmed:** whether the Emfuleni "Log a Service Fault" form issues reference numbers was not fully confirmed (the form flow couldn't be fully walked). This is flagged as an open question (R-03) and a PAIA question.
- **Municipal staff unreachable:** the municipality failed to provide comment when asked (South Africa Today, 13 April 2026). Several inferences about internal processes (prioritisation rules, internal SDBIP indicator interpretation, per-report outcomes) are therefore inferences from public signals, not direct confirmation — flagged as [M] where applicable.
- **AFriForum MOU outcome not confirmed:** the Aug 2025 AfriForum–Emfuleni MOU discussion (Acting Executive Mayor Tumi Mochawe) said they'd meet again 1 Sept 2025; whether it was finalised/ implemented is not confirmed. Flagged as a verification item.
- **"4 deaths" claim unverified:** included as a serious allegation warranting investigation, not as established fact (Section 14.3; R-05).
- **VFC post location tag:** the VFC/ Gatvol Voiceforchange post carries #Matjhabeng (Free State/Goldfields area) — verify whether the specific potholes are Emfuleni roads or Free State roads before attributing to Emfuleni; the group's general pattern is on point regardless.
- **Municipal Money profile:** the page is JS-rendered; specific figures (cash balance, capital spending, repairs & maintenance % of assets, debtors collection) were not captured as exact

numbers here — flagged as available public indicators to screenshot/ cite directly when building the accountability view.

- **Currency of figures:** figures are drawn from the latest available sources to date (late 2025–2026). Some (e.g. PotholeFixGP numbers) are as of June 2025; some Emfuleni figures (MIG, unfunded budget, liquidity) are 2025–2026. Treat as current to the extent of the source date, and refresh before external use.

End of document: Phase 1 (Planning)